

JKBOSE 2026

CLASS 11TH

MOTHER'S DAY

LECTURE-1

ENGLISH

HUSSAIN SIR



Topics To Covered

1 ... Lec. 01. (Mother's day) Play.

2 ...
 ⇒ Detailed Summary.
 ⇒ Textual questions.

3 ...

4 ...

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



- J.B. Priestley was a famous British novelist, playwright, and broadcaster. He is best known for his plays that combine ^{fun} humour with social criticism. Priestley strongly believed in social equality, justice, and the importance of moral responsibility.
- He served in World War I, which deeply influenced his writings. One of his most famous plays is "An Inspector Calls", where he explores the theme of social responsibility.
- In his play "Mother's Day," he highlights how mothers are often unappreciated and uses satire and role reversal to bring attention to gender roles in the family.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



CHARACTERS:

1. **Mrs. Annie Pearson** – A ^{very loving} devoted, ^{kind} gentle housewife who is taken for granted by her family.
2. **Mr. George Pearson** – Her husband; ^{too proud} pompous and self-centered.
3. **Doris Pearson** – Her daughter; modern, rude, and disrespectful to her mother.
4. **Cyril Pearson** – Her son; equally inconsiderate and demanding.
5. **Mrs. Fitzgerald** – The neighbour; ^{confident} a strong, assertive woman who helps Annie take a stand.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley

- The play starts with a scene of Mrs Pearson and Mrs Fitzgerald drinking tea during an afternoon in early autumn. Mrs Fitzgerald is a fortune teller and is telling Mrs Pearson's fortune. Both of them have contrasting personalities. While Mrs Pearson looks ^{nice & friendly} pleasant but ^{worried} anxious, Mrs Fitzgerald looks stronger with a ^{seemingly evil} sinister personality. The former is in her ^{40's} forties, and the latter is older.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



- The conversation starts with Mrs Fitzgerald advising Mrs Pearson ^{defend your rights} to take a stand and be the boss of her own family. Mrs Pearson replies meekly that it was not that simple – she was still ^{loving} fond of them even if they were thoughtless and selfish. Mrs Fitzgerald reminds her that it is not acceptable to be treated the way she was treated by her children and her husband. Mrs Pearson replies ^{doubtfully} dubiously that she does try to drop them a hint, and she does not know how to begin. She looks at the clock and panics, saying they will be home soon and nothing is ready.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



- Mrs Fitzgerald tries to ^{to make relaxed} calm her down and asks Mrs Pearson to put her foot down, but Mrs Pearson does not seem to be sure about her capabilities. To this, Mrs Fitzgerald replies that she will do it for Mrs Pearson. The latter denies politely explaining that her husband and children would ^{angry} resent Mrs Fitzgerald. Then Mrs Fitzgerald reveals her plan, which involves an exchange of their personalities. She then takes Mrs Pearson's hands and chants a spell, after which Mrs Pearson talks out of Mrs Fitzgerald's body and vice versa.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



- Mrs Pearson, who is now Mrs Fitzgerald, sounded ^{worried} alarmed at this ^{change} transformation and expressed her fear – in case they were not able to reverse their personalities into their own respective bodies. Mrs Fitzgerald, who is now Mrs Pearson, convinced her not to worry and go to her home. She could come back after some time to check on things. Mrs Fitzgerald hurries back to her house while the real Mrs Fitzgerald, in the form of Mrs Pearson, waits for the children and husband to return home from work. She smokes away carelessly, whereas the real Mrs Pearson has never smoked in her life.

Mother's Day *J.B. Priestley*



- The daughter Doris, a pretty young girl in her twenties, bursts inside the room asking her mother to iron her yellow silk dress because she is going out for the night. She notices her mother smoking and starts questioning her. Mrs Pearson calmly retaliates, saying there is no law against smoking. When Doris asks her mother if tea is ready, Mrs Pearson informs her that she has had her tea and is thinking about going for dinner at Clarendon. Doris, who has now become ^{upset} sulky, reminds her mother that she works hard and Mrs Pearson has always prepared tea and ironed clothes for her. Mrs Pearson rebukes Doris's comments and reminds her that she works twice as much as Doris but gets paid in neither wages nor thanks. She also goes further to insult Charlie Spence, with whom Doris had planned to go out in the evening in her yellow dress. Doris is on the ^{close to} verge of tears.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



- Mrs Pearson's son Cyril arrives home after a while and starts asking for tea and things that he needs for going out in the evening. In a similar manner to how she put down Doris, Mrs Pearson replies rudely curtly to Cyril's demands and queries – implying that she could not care less. She reminds Cyril that everyone in the family expects her to listen to their rude comments and demands. She has decided to fight against it just like Cyril goes to the Union in case of any problems discrepancies at work.

Mother's Day J.B. Priestley



- As Cyril stands there ^{confused} baffled by Mrs Pearson's unnatural behaviour, Doris joins him in the living room. She had been crying, and her mother just aggravates the situation by telling her that a crying face does not suit her for an evening out with Charlie Spencer. As Cyril tries to figure out what Mrs Pearson could have possibly said to Doris, he finds her looking for some stout in the kitchen. Cyril and Doris talk to each other about the new development in Mrs Pearsons's attitude. They find the thought of their father dealing with Mrs Pearson's behaviour funnily intriguing and wait for his arrival.

Mother's Day *J.B. Priestley*



- As Mrs Pearson enters the drawing room with her stout, she intercepts the siblings' laughter and giggles and ^{scolds} reprimands them for not behaving their age. When Doris asks the reason behind her sudden change in behaviour, Mrs Pearson replies that all the family members do is come home, ask her for something and go back again. She also threatens them by saying that her work of eight hours is done and that she might go for an outing during the weekend.

Mother's Day *J.B. Priestley*



- The husband, George, arrives home and is treated in the same way as Cyril and Doris. Mrs Pearson also goes ahead to tell him how people at the club called him 'Pompyompy George'. Mrs Fitzgerald enters the house now and is worried about how Mrs Pearson is treating the family members. She begs Mrs Pearson to stop, but the latter seems furious at her family's behaviour and scolds them to learn some manners. Mrs Fitzgerald asks Mrs Pearson to exchange their personalities back while Mrs Pearson is intent on doing some more reforms in the family members' behaviours. But Mrs Fitzgerald is no longer able to bear it, and Mrs Pearson exchanges their personalities back.

Mother's Day *J.B. Priestley*



- The original Mrs Pearson starts talking in a pleasant manner while Mrs Fitzgerald reminds her to be strict. Mrs Pearson thus uses a strict tone with her family finally, and all seem to be aware of her problems and needs now. Cyril, Doris and George become polite and understanding in their behaviour towards Mrs Pearson. She proposes a nice game of rummy and asks them to help her with supper. Mrs Fitzgerald wishes the family goodnight and leaves the house. The play ends.

QUESTION



What is the central theme of the play?

- 1**  Respect for mothers and women
- 2** Importance of education
- 3** Patriotism
- 4** Role of money in life

QUESTION



What kind of woman is Mrs. Pearson at the beginning of the play?

- 1 Bold and rude
- 2 Quiet, gentle, and submissive 
- 3 Arrogant and proud
- 4 Lazy and careless

QUESTION



Who suggests the idea of swapping personalities?

- 1 Doris Pearson
- 2 George Pearson
- 3 Cyril Pearson
- 4 Mrs. Fitzgerald 

QUESTION



What is the relationship between Mrs. Pearson and Mrs. Fitzgerald?

- 1 Sisters
- 2 Cousins
- 3 Neighbours 
- 4 Colleagues

QUESTION



Why is Doris shocked when she enters the room?

- 1 Her mother is not home
- 2 Her mother is dancing
- 3  Her mother is smoking and not doing housework
- 4 Her father is crying

QUESTION



What effect does Mrs. Pearson's new behavior have on her family?

- 1 They get angry
- 2 They ignore her
- 3  They begin to realize their mistakes
- 4 They leave the house

QUESTION



What does the play mainly criticize?

- 1 Politics
- 2 Teachers
- 3 Technology
- 4 Family's disrespect towards mothers

QUESTION



What lesson does the family learn at the end of the play?

- 1 To avoid clubs
- 2 To fear magic
- 3 To listen only to Mrs. Fitzgerald
- 4 To respect and support their mother

QUESTION



This play, written in the 1950s, is a humorous and satirical depiction of the status of the mother in the family.

(i) What are the issues it raises?

ANSWER:

The main issue raised by the play is that the lady of the house, who functions similarly to an axis, is never given due respect, especially if she is a simple housewife. The members of her family take her for granted. She is like an unpaid servant. The second problem is that the mistress of the house ought to be firm in her stance. Rather than surrendering meekly, she should be prepared to argue her case with tenacity.

QUESTION



(ii) Do you think it caricatures these issues or do you think that the problems it raises are genuine? How does the play resolve the issues? Do you agree with the resolution?

ANSWER:

No, I don't think it caricatures these issues, because the problems raised by it are genuine.

The play helps to solve these issues by showing the audience what tends to happen if the mother neglects her responsibilities. Yes, I agree with the proposed resolution. Every member of the family should spend some time with the angel who has brought so much colour to the family.

QUESTION



If you were to write about these issues today what are some of the incidents, examples and problems that you would think of as relevant?

Important

ANSWER:

If I were to start writing about certain current issues, I wouldn't have to go far looking for examples. The same thing happens in my house. We are three brothers and a sister who are all in school. My father is employed. My mother gets up early in the morning to prepare four breakfast sets and tiffins. We take our time getting ready, but if there is even a 5-second delay on my mother's part, we all bring the roof down. The same ritual is performed in the evening. Mother gets up before the rest of us and goes to bed after the rest of us. Her presence had been taken for granted by all of us. My grandmother became ill one day, and my mother had to leave for two days. Without her, the entire house appeared to have been hit by a tornado. We all decided to wait for her as if we were expecting a miracle to occur.

When she eventually appeared, we all breathed a sigh of relief and vowed never to underestimate her.

QUESTION



Is drama a good medium for conveying a social message? Discuss

ANSWER:

Yes, drama is an effective medium for communicating a social message. It is an excellent platform for displaying most such problems and solutions in a matter of minutes. People have a great attachment to dramas and are likely to remember them for a long time. Dramas undoubtedly play a significant role in bringing about social change.

QUESTION



Discuss in groups plays or films with a strong message of social reform that you have watched.

Do it yourself.

QUESTION



Character Sketch: Mrs. Annie Pearson.

⇒ H/W

ANSWER:

Mrs. Annie Pearson is a middle-aged, devoted housewife who is kind-hearted, gentle, and caring. She spends all her time looking after her husband and children, but sadly, they do not value or respect her efforts. Her family treats her like a servant and takes her completely for granted. At the beginning of the play, Mrs. Pearson appears nervous, self-doubting, and unable to stand up for herself. She wants peace in the family and avoids any confrontation, even if she is being treated unfairly. However, with the help of her assertive neighbour, Mrs.

Fitzgerald, Mrs. Pearson transforms. Through the personality swap, she learns how to be firm and assertive. She begins to demand the respect she deserves and shows that a mother is not a servant but an important part of the family. By the end of the play, she gains confidence, and her family begins to realize her value.

QUESTION



Give a brief character-sketch of Mrs Fitzgerald

ANSWER:

HW

Mrs. Fitzgerald is Mrs. Pearson's neighbour and a strong, bold, and assertive woman. She is completely different from Mrs. Pearson—confident, outspoken, and fearless. She has a deep sense of justice and cannot tolerate how Mrs. Pearson is treated unfairly by her own family. She understands Mrs. Pearson's problems and suggests a unique and magical solution: they swap personalities so that she (in Mrs. Pearson's body) can teach the family a lesson. This shows that she is also smart, practical, and creative. While speaking in Mrs. Pearson's body, she fearlessly puts everyone in their place, exposing their selfishness and correcting their behavior. She uses sharp wit and sarcasm to make them realize how they've mistreated their mother. Mrs. Fitzgerald plays a crucial role in changing the dynamics of the Pearson household. Her actions bring about respect, balance, and fairness in the family.

QUESTION



After reading the play 'Mother's Day', do you think the status of your mother in your family need to be changed? What do you think she lacks the most, that needs to be addressed to?

(19/10)

ANSWER:

After reading the play Mother's Day by J.B. Priestley, I realize how often mothers are taken for granted in many families, including mine. They silently take on the burden of cooking, cleaning, and caring for everyone, while their own needs and feelings are often ignored.

In my family too, my mother works very hard from morning to night, yet we rarely express our appreciation. She never complains, but I now feel that she lacks recognition and rest, which she truly deserves. She may not say it, but I believe she misses:

Time for herself (to rest or follow her own hobbies)

Verbal appreciation for everything she does

Help from other family members in daily chores

Respect in decision-making at home

This play taught me that love is not enough—respect and equality are just as important. It's time we all treat our mothers not just as caregivers, but as individuals with their own dignity, emotions, and needs.

Thank
You

